Lesson 5 · Evaluating a strategy with evidence

Name: Class: Date:

Source A

Source A: Brazil before and after Bolsa Família

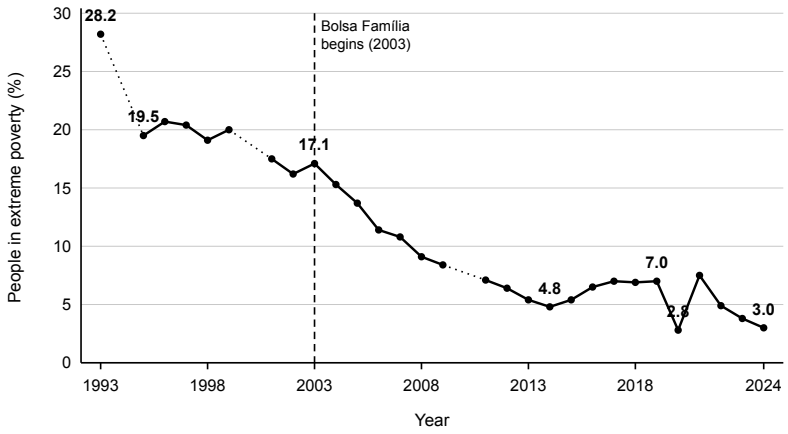
Indicator (Brazil)	1993	2003 (Bolsa Família begins)	2008	2024
People living in extreme poverty (%)	28.2	17.1	9.1	3.0
Deaths of children under 5 (per 1,000 live births)	53.9	28.2	20.5	14.2
Share of national income earned by the poorest 20% of people (%)	2.4	2.6	3.2	3.9

Extreme poverty: living on less than US$3.00 a day (adjusted for prices in 2021). Source: World Bank, World Development Indicators, accessed 20 October 2026.

Source B: Brazil's Bolsa Família

In October 2003, Brazil's national government started Bolsa Família (Family Grant) by combining several smaller payment schemes. Poor families receive a monthly cash payment, usually paid to the woman of the household. In return, children must attend school regularly, and families must keep up vaccinations and health check-ups, including during pregnancy. The programme grew from about 6 million families in 2004 to about 14 million in 2014, but cost only about 0.5% of Brazil's GDP. In 2021 it was replaced by a similar scheme, then brought back in 2023, and in 2025 it reached nearly 20 million families. A 2019 government study found that it reduced extreme poverty by about a quarter, but that the payments were small.

People in Brazil living in extreme poverty, 1993–2024



Dotted sections: no data for 1994, 2000 and 2010. The low figure in 2020 followed separate COVID-19 emergency payments. Sources: Government of Brazil (laws of 2003, 2004 and 2023); IPEA (2019); World Bank (2025); graph: World Bank, World Development Indicators, accessed 20 October 2026.

We do: the effect on children's health (copy our class paragraph)

Evaluate how effective Bolsa Família has been in improving the health of Brazil's children. Use Sources A and B.

Judgement:

Evidence 1:

Evidence 2:

Limitation (However… / Although…):

Restated judgement:

Five kinds of limitation: already happening before? · not sustained? · gaps remain? · other causes? · scale or reach?

You do: the effect on inequality

Evaluate how effective Bolsa Família has been in reducing inequality between rich and poor people in Brazil. Use Sources A and B. Write ONE paragraph (about 120–150 words): a clear judgement, at least TWO pieces of evidence, at least ONE limitation using *however* or *although*, and your judgement restated.

Judgement *Highly, largely, partly or not very effective? Why?*	
Evidence 1 *Data, and what it shows*	
Evidence 2 *Data, and what it shows*	
Limitation *However… / Although…*	
Final sentence *Restate your judgement*	

You do: sentence starters (scaffolded version)

Judgement: Bolsa Família has been _____ effective in reducing inequality in Brazil.

Evidence 1: Since its introduction in 2003, the share of national income earned by the poorest 20% of people has risen from _____ to _____, which shows that _____.

Evidence 2: In addition, the fall in extreme poverty from _____ to _____ suggests that _____.

Limitation: However, _____, which means that _____.

Restated judgement: Overall, although _____, Bolsa Família has _____.

largely | partly | significantly | the introduction of | the reduction in | inequality | living standards | wellbeing | whereas | which suggests that

Exit ticket (or use a sticky note): write ONE limitation sentence about Bolsa Família. Start with *However* or *Although*, and include data.

_____

_____

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